

ANNA ELENA SCHMID, PHD

Climate Economist | Researcher | Data Scientist | Innovative Thinker

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EXPERIENCE

Research Associate

Zurich University of Applied Sciences 06/2026 - Present Zürich, Switzerland

Climate and Agricultural Data Scientist

CinSOIL 06/2025 - 12/2025 Berlin, Germany

PhD in Climate Economics

University of Bern 02/2020 - 12/2024 Bern, Switzerland

Research Stay

Columbia University 07/2023 - 02/2024 New York, United States

Academic Intern

Federal Office of Meteorology and Climatology 04/2019 - 12/2019

Zurich, Switzerland

Assistant Competence Centres Volunteering and Youth Work

Swiss Red Cross 01/2016 - 07/2016 Bern, Switzerland

Assistant Event Management

TMGZ Theatre Casino 09/2011 - 03/2012 Zug, Switzerland

PROJECTS

Co-Founder, Project Manager and President

2015 - 2019 Zürich, Switzerland

Co-founded VoCHabular, a volunteer project creating tools to help refugees learn German and Swiss German and feel more at home.

- > 60 Volunteers, > 3600 Distributed Books, > 15 Spoken Languages

SKILLS

R • Python • STATA • Statistics • Data Analysis • LaTeX • Project Management • GitHub •

Survey Design • Machine Learning • MS Office • Adobe InDesign • Science Communication •

Cooperative • Can Take Criticism • Sociable • Resilient • Creative

EDUCATION

EIT Food Innovator Fellowship

European Institute for Innovation - Technology

06/2025 - 12/2025 Berlin, Germany

Graduate School of Climate Sciences, PhD

Oeschger Centre for Climate Change Research

02/2020 - 12/2024 Bern, Switzerland

Program for Doctoral Students

Zurich Graduate School of Economics

08/2020 - 06/2021 Zurich, Switzerland

MSc in Applied Economic Analysis

University of Bern

09/2016 - 01/2019 Bern, Switzerland

BA in Social Sciences

University of Bern

09/2012 - 01/2016 Bern, Switzerland

SEMINARS, CONFERENCES & WORKSHOPS

ICAE (New Delhi), AAEA (New Orleans), AES (Edinburgh), AAEA (Washington, D.C.), AES (Warwick), Winter School on Machine Learning (ML and DNN, TensorFlow) (Mürren), Labor Market and Economic Geography (Bern), Shifting Landscapes, LSE (London), Scientific Retreat (Lenk), Ph.D. Seminar (Bern), Machine Learning for Weather and Climate Modeling (Bern), Summer School on Vegetation, Land Surface and Climate Interactions (ETH Zurich), Annual Workshop of the Verein für Socialpolitik (Oldenburg)

SUMMARY

I build models, design surveys, and write code to understand how climate change affects farmers, food systems, and the people who depend on them. My PhD at the University of Bern combined econometrics, phenological modelling, and machine learning to quantify agricultural climate risks, with a research stay at Columbia and fieldwork with actual farmers. Since then: satellite data fusion at CinSOIL, agrivoltaics at EIT Food, conferences on four continents. I work best at the intersection of rigorous methods and real problems.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

Innovative Climate Research

Experimental & Survey-Based Insights

Academic Leadership & Advocacy

Founding & Scaling voCHabular

LANGUAGES

Swiss German	Native	
German	Fluent	
English	Fluent	
French	Advanced	
Persian	Basic	
Spanish	Basic	

VOLUNTEERING

Volunteer Lead Rescuer

Rescuing Leftover Cuisine

New York, United States

Volunteer

Swiss Climate Protection Association

Zurich, Switzerland

Volunteer Husky Trainer

Cold Nose Huskies

Gargnäs, Swedish Lappland

Mentor (Incluso Program)

Caritas

Zurich, Switzerland

INSTITUTIONAL TASKS

Representative of the Doctoral Students

University of Bern

Student Body of the Faculty of Social Sciences

University of Bern

AWARDS / GRANTS

SNSF Mobility Grant (Swiss National Science Foundation) | CHF 11'679

VBW-Excellence Award, Third Best Master Thesis | CHF 400